

Miaplacidus
225 Suns

Theta Carinae
1,360 Suns

Epsilon Carinae
5,405 Suns

NGC 3372

Better known as the Carina Nebula, a large, diffuse nebula about four times the apparent width of the Full Moon; includes the erratic variable star Eta Carinae

NGC 3114

A large open cluster, similar in size to NGC 2516 but fainter because it is twice as far away, some 3,000 light-years from Earth

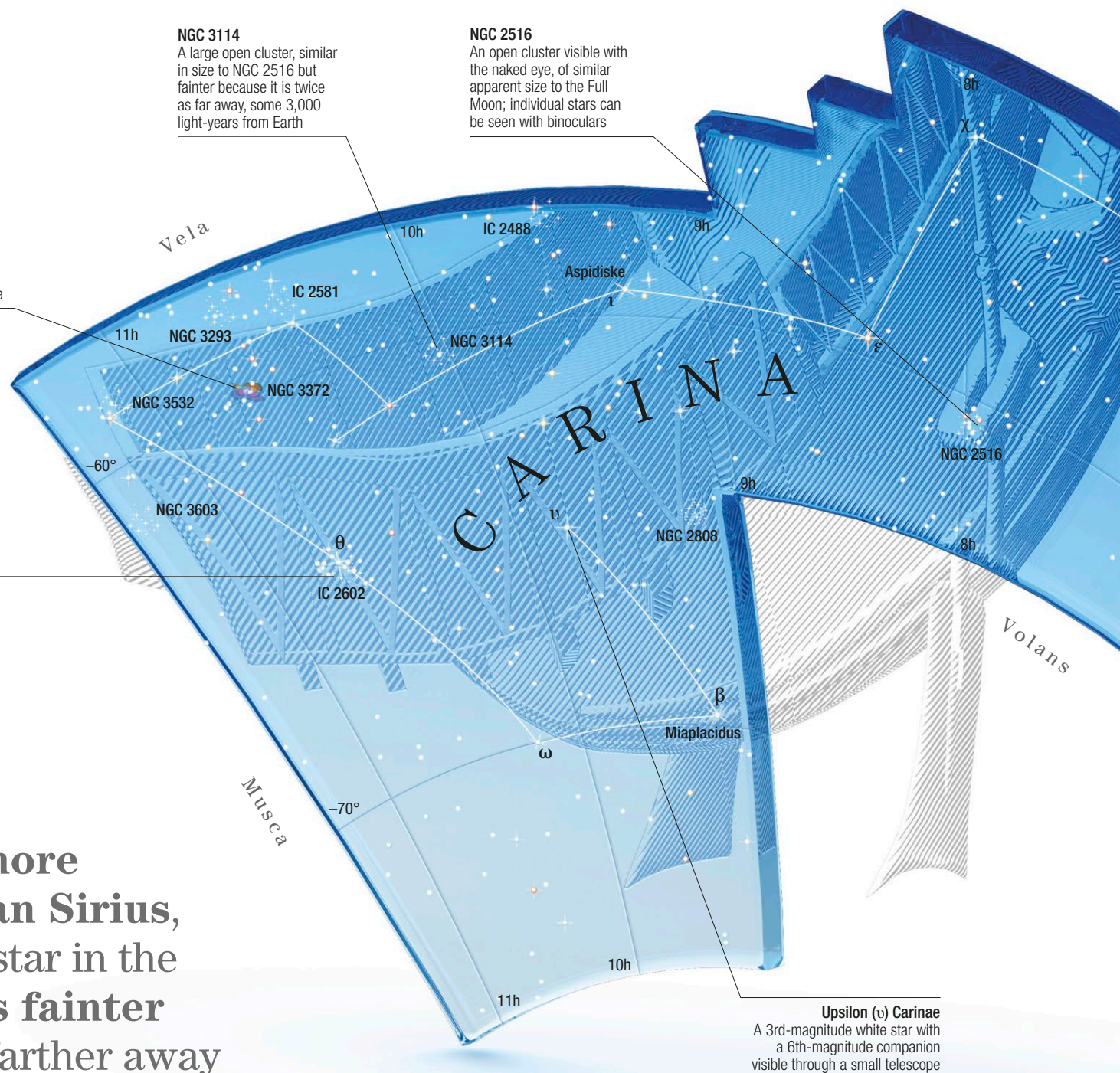
NGC 2516

An open cluster visible with the naked eye, of similar apparent size to the Full Moon; individual stars can be seen with binoculars

IC 2602

Also known as the Southern Pleiades, an open cluster twice the apparent size of the Full Moon and easily visible with the naked eye; its brightest member is Theta (θ) Carinae

Canopus is more luminous than Sirius, the brightest star in the sky, but looks fainter because it is farther away



Upsilon (υ) Carinae

A 3rd-magnitude white star with a 6th-magnitude companion visible through a small telescope

▷ **Star distances**

Carina's main pattern stars lie between 113 and about 1,400 light-years from Earth. The constellation's two brightest stars, Canopus (α) and Miaplacidus (β), are also the two nearest of the pattern stars. The farthest star, Upsilon (υ) Carinae, is an outlier, lying about twice as far from Earth as the second-farthest pattern star, Iota (ι) Carinae.

